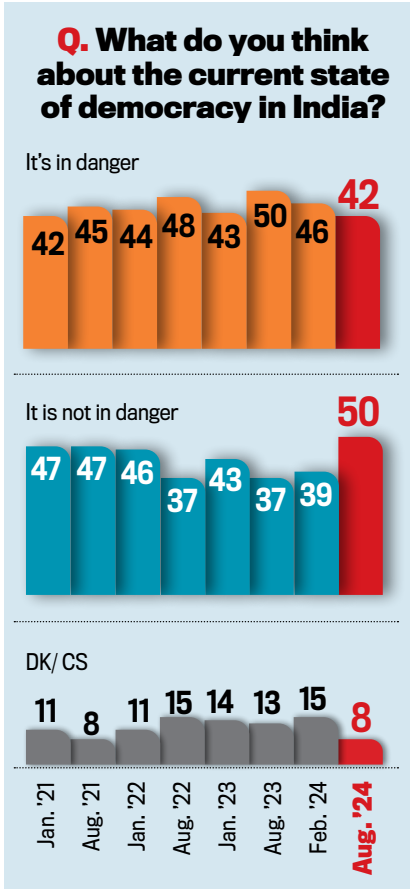
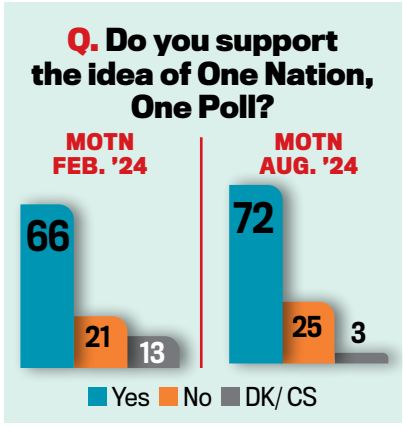
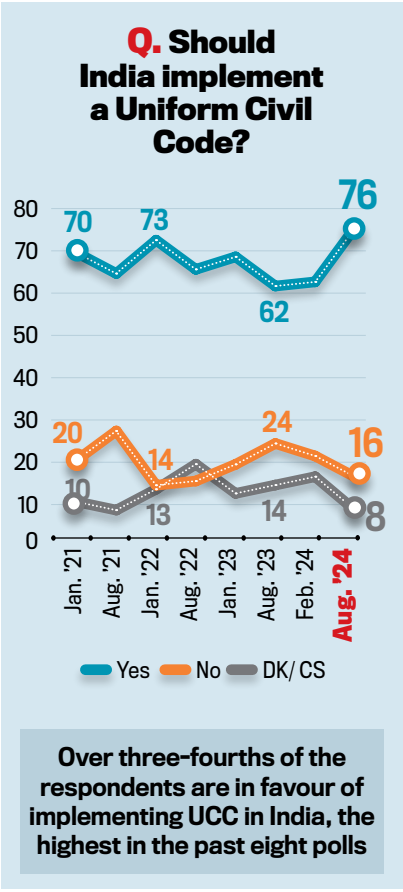








All figures in % and rounded off

The three new criminal laws—the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, which on July 1 replaced the British-era Indian Penal Code (IPC), Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC) and Indian Evidence Act, respectively—are seen as a positive reform by many, but with caveats. While nearly a third, or 31.1 per cent, welcome them but with checks, 22 per cent believe they work well as is. However, as many as 22.4 per cent express concerns and feel the new laws are dangerous as they place excessive power in the hands of the police and the executive, these apprehensions being the highest in the South (36 per cent).

The Agnipath scheme for military recruitments elicits mixed reactions too. Given that employment in the armed forces, even if for a limited tenure, brings with it a lot of prestige and a chance of retention for the Agniveers, almost a fourth of the respondents—27 per cent—feel the scheme should continue sans any change. But nearly an equal number—26.8 per cent—want it to be shelved altogether and a considerable 38.3 per cent seek some improvements, reflecting the prevailing scepticism about the scheme.

59%

of the respondents across India feel free to express their opinions on politics and religion, as against about 36% who don't feel free on either or both counts

Amid the ongoing consultations for the implementation of One Nation, One Poll (ONOP), public opinion seems to be crystallising sharply in its favour—72.4 per cent of the respondents, up from 65.9 per cent surveyed in the Feb. 2024 survey. But the percentage of those against ONOP has also risen, from 21.3 in February to 25.2 at present. This leaves just 2.5 per cent of the respondents who are either unaware or undecided about the efficacy of the concept. But the Election Commission's decision to hold the upcoming assembly elections in Haryana and Maharashtra separately, even as they were conducted simultaneously on the past three occasions, raises the question whether realpolitik will ultimately trump ONOP, which is being touted as a